Care Companion

User Manual

A simple guide for families and their elders

Everything this app can do, explained in plain language.
No technical knowledge needed.

Welcome

Care Companion helps a family look after an older parent or relative, even when you are not in the same house.

The app works across **two phones** at the same time:

Phone	Who uses it	What it looks like
Your phone (the Guardian)	The son, daughter or family member doing the organising.	A normal app with a dashboard. You add medicines, contacts and reminders, and you receive emergency alerts.
Their phone (the Elder)	The older person being cared for.	Very large buttons, very few of them, and a big red SOS button. Nothing to set up, nothing to configure, nothing that can be broken by accident.

You do all the work on your phone. Their phone simply shows the results: today's medicines, the people they can call, and a way to shout for help.

> **You will need**
>
> Two Android phones, a Google account on each one, and an internet connection on both. That is all — there is nothing to buy and no account to create.

How to read this manual

- **Part 1** is for you, the family member. Start here — the elder's phone cannot be set up until you have made their profile.
- **Part 2** is what the elder sees. Read it so you can explain it to them.
- **Part 3** walks through an ordinary day, and what happens in an emergency.
- **Part 4** is what to do when something does not look right.

Before you start — putting the app on both phones

Care Companion is one app. The same file goes on both phones; the app asks who you are the first time it opens and shows the right screens from then on.

What you need	Why
An Android phone, version 7.0 or newer, on each side	The app is built for Android 7.0 (2016) and newer, so an older, cheaper handset is fine for the elder.
About 50 MB of free space on each phone	The app file is 21 MB; Android needs roughly the same again while it installs.
A working internet connection, Wi-Fi or mobile data	The two phones talk to each other through the internet. Reminders that are already set still go off without it.
The elder's own mobile number	This is what links their phone to the profile you create.

Installing it

1. Copy the file **CareCompanion.apk** to the phone, or open the download link you were sent.
2. Tap the file. Android will ask whether to allow installing from this source — say yes for the app you are using to open it (usually Files or Chrome).
3. Tap **Install**, then **Open**.
4. Choose **I look after someone** on your phone, and **I am the elder** on theirs.

> **The permissions it asks for, and why**
>
> **Notifications** — so reminders and emergency alerts can appear. **Alarms and reminders** — so a dose reminder goes off at the exact minute, even if the phone has been idle. **Location** — read once, only at the moment SOS is pressed, so the family knows where to go. **Microphone** — only while the elder is answering a spoken reminder. **Contacts** — only when you choose to import one person from the address book. Saying no to any of these leaves the rest of the app working.

Part 1 — Your phone

Setting everything up and looking after it day to day.

1. Signing in

Open Care Companion. The first screen asks **“Who is using this phone?”**

1. Tap **Guardian User**.
2. Tap **Sign in with Google**.

3 Choose your Google account from the list that appears.

That is the whole sign-in. There is no password to invent and no code sent by SMS. You stay signed in afterwards — you will not be asked again unless you log out.

> **Choose carefully**
>
> Pick the Google account you will keep using. Everything you create is tied to it. If you sign in with a different account later, you will not see the profiles you made with the first one.

2. Creating the elder's profile

This is the record of the person you are caring for. Everything else hangs off it.

1 On the dashboard, tap the **+** beside the profile circles at the top.

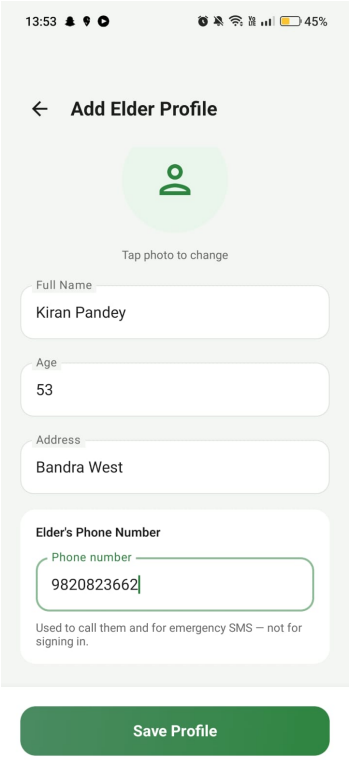
2 Tap the photo circle to add their picture. This is worth doing — the elder recognises faces far more easily than names.

3 Fill in their **Full Name**, **Age** and **Address**.

4 Enter their **Phone Number**. This is used for calling them and for emergency messages — it is *not* used to sign in.

5 Tap **Save Profile**.

You can create more than one profile if you look after two people. Their circles appear side by side at the top of the dashboard, and you tap a circle to switch between them.



Picture 1. Guardian phone, step 2. The new-elder form. Name, age and the elder's own mobile number are the three fields that matter; the number is what links the two phones later.

3. Connecting the elder's phone

This is the one step people find confusing, so here it is slowly. It happens **once**, and never again.

Because signing in now uses a Google account, the app cannot tell on its own which phone belongs to which profile. So you are given a short code that joins the two together.

1. Open the elder's profile and scroll to **Connect [name]'s phone**.
2. You will see a **6-digit code** in large green numbers.
3. Tap **Copy** or **Share** to send it to yourself, or simply read it out — whatever is easiest.
4. Now pick up the **elder's phone**. Install Care Companion and open it.
5. Tap **Elder User**, then **Sign in with Google**, and choose their account.
6. The screen says **“Enter your code”**. Type the 6 digits and tap **Connect**.

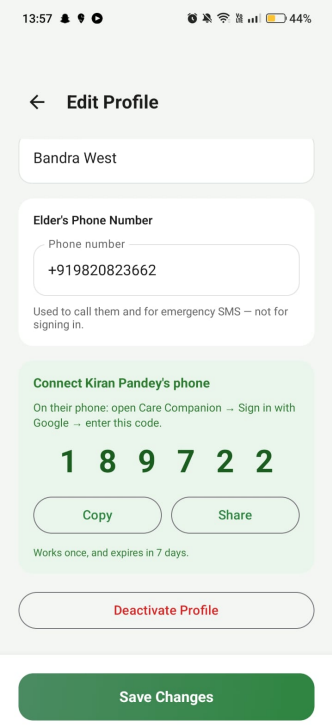
Their phone now shows their home screen. From this moment on they simply open the app — no code, no sign-in, ever again.

About the code

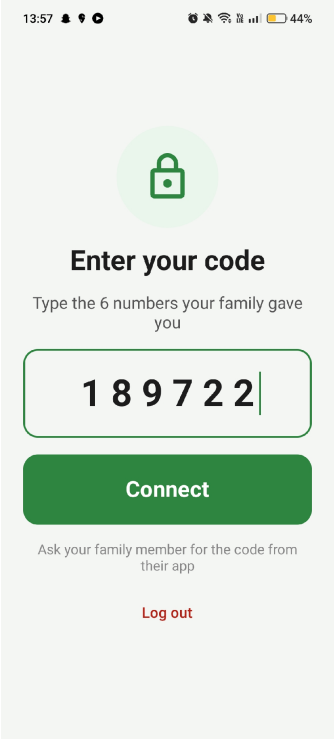
It works **once** and expires after **7 days**. If it stops working, open the profile again and a fresh code will be waiting. This is deliberate: a code that lived forever would be a way into someone's health information.

Doing this together is easiest

Most families do the whole thing sitting side by side, with the family member typing the code into the elder's phone themselves. That is completely fine.



Picture 2. Guardian phone, step 3. The six-digit connect code, with Copy and Share.



Picture 3. Elder phone, step 3. The same code typed in here joins the two phones.

4. The dashboard

Your home screen. The top shows who you are caring for; the coloured tiles below are everything you can do.

Tile	What it is for
Contacts	The people the elder can call, with their photos.
Medicines	Add and manage each medicine.
Schedule	Set the days and times a medicine should be taken.
Reminders	Other nudges — drink water, go for a walk, check vitals.
Vitals	Blood pressure, sugar, temperature and pulse readings.
Adherence	Which doses were actually taken, and which were missed.
Videos	Shortcuts to YouTube, WhatsApp and similar, for their home screen.
Wheelchair	Assistance and service contacts.
Family	Let another relative see the profile too.
SOS Alerts	Emergency alerts they have raised, and marking them resolved.

At the very top you will also see a **SAFE** badge and a bell icon. The bell carries a red number when there is something new for you to look at. Along the bottom are **Home**, **Alerts** and **Settings**.

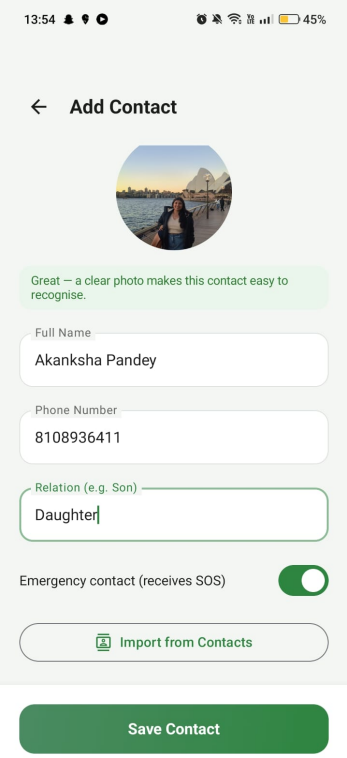
5. Contacts

The people the elder can reach with one tap. Add these before anything else — they matter most in an emergency.

1. Open **Contacts** and tap the green **+**.
2. Add a photo. On the elder's phone people appear as *faces*, not names, so this is the single most useful thing you can do for them.
3. Enter the **Full Name** and **Phone Number**.
4. Fill in **Relation** — Daughter, Son, Doctor, Neighbour.
5. Turn on **Emergency contact** if this person should be reachable when SOS is pressed.
6. Tap **Save Contact**.

Import from Contacts pulls a name and number straight from your phone's address book, so you do not have to type them.

> **Mark at least one emergency contact**
>
> If nobody is marked as an emergency contact, the elder's SOS screen has no one to offer them to call. Take a moment to check this.



Picture 4. Guardian phone, step 5. A contact saved with a photograph and the emergency switch turned on. The photograph is what the elder recognises; the switch is what puts this person on the SOS list.

6. Medicines

Each medicine is added once, then given a schedule. They are two separate steps.

1. Open **Medicines** and tap the green **+**.
2. Enter the **Name** — use whatever the elder calls it, not the pharmacy's long name.
3. Enter the **Dosage**, such as “1 tablet” or “5 ml”.
4. Choose the **Form**: tablet, syrup, and so on.
5. Choose whether it is taken **with water** or **with milk**, and **before** or **after** a meal.
6. You can add photos of the pill and of the packet, front and back. The pill photo shows on the elder's screen at the moment they take it, which helps them be sure they have the right one.
7. Tap **Save Medicine**.

Back on the Medicines list, each medicine has three actions: **Edit**, **Schedule**, and **Remove**. The switch on the right pauses a medicine without deleting it — useful when a course finishes but may start again.

7. Schedule — when to take it

Nothing appears on the elder's phone until a medicine has a schedule. This is the step people most often forget.

1. On the Medicines list, tap **Schedule** under the medicine.
2. **Days** — tap the circles to choose days. Green means on. **Every day** and **Mon–Fri** set them in one tap.
3. **Meal** — choose Breakfast, Lunch or Dinner, and whether it is before or after the meal.
4. **Time** — pick one of the suggested times, or tap **Pick time** for any time you like.
5. **Water** — turn on if it should be taken with water.
6. Tap **Save Schedule**.

You can add several schedules to the same medicine — for example one at 8 in the morning and one at 9 at night. Just repeat the steps.

> **Check it worked**
>
> After saving you are returned to the Medicines list, and the medicine now shows a small green label such as **Breakfast · 08:00**. If you do not see that label, the schedule did not save — try again.

8. Reminders

Nudges that are not medicines: drinking water, going for a walk, checking blood pressure.

1. Open **Reminders** and tap the green **+**.
2. Choose a category — Water, Walk or Vitals — or write your own title.
3. Choose the **times** of day. You can set several.
4. Choose the **days** of the week.
5. Save.

The elder's phone will show a notification at each time. The categories along the top of the screen — All, Medicine, Water, Walk, Vitals — filter the list.

> **Medicines are not set up here**
>
> Medicine reminders come from the Schedule screen, not this one. The note at the top of the Reminders screen says the same thing.

9. Vitals

A record of blood pressure, sugar, temperature and pulse over time.

1. Open **Vitals** and tap the green **+**.
2. Choose **Blood Pressure**, **Sugar**, **Temperature** or **Pulse**.
3. For blood pressure, enter both the upper (systolic) and lower (diastolic) numbers.
4. For sugar, say whether it was taken fasting or after a meal.
5. Tap **Save reading**. The date and time are recorded for you.

Each reading is labelled **Normal**, **Borderline** or **High** so you can see at a glance whether something has changed. **Export PDF** at the top produces a file you can send to a doctor or show at an appointment.

> **These labels are not medical advice**
>
> They are general guides to help you spot a change worth mentioning. The app never tells anyone to change a medicine or a dose. Always talk to a doctor.

The elder can also record their own readings on their phone, and those appear here too.

10. Adherence

Whether medicines are actually being taken.

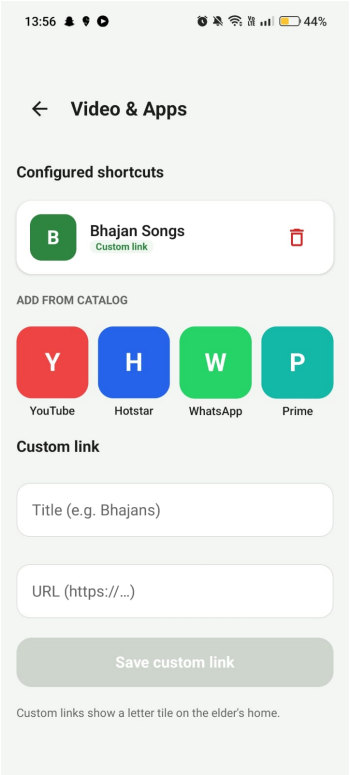
Every time the elder answers **Taken** or **Not taken** on their phone, it is recorded here. A dose nobody answered is marked as missed. This is how you notice a pattern — a dose regularly missed at night, for instance — without having to telephone and ask every day.

11. Videos and apps

Big shortcut buttons on the elder's home screen.

1. Open **Videos**.
2. Tap **YouTube**, **Hotstar**, **WhatsApp** or **Prime** to add it.
3. Or paste a link under **Custom link** — a favourite devotional playlist, a family photo album — give it a title and save.

Each one becomes a large button under **Videos** on their phone. Custom links show as a coloured letter tile.



Picture 5. Guardian phone, step 11. Video and app shortcuts. Whatever is switched on here is what appears on the elder's Videos screen.

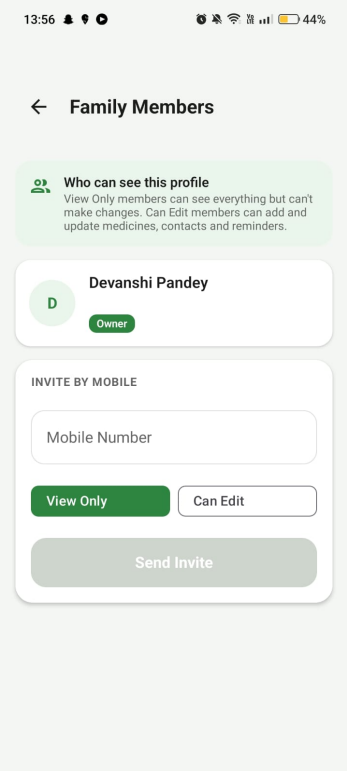
12. Family members

Let another relative see and help with the same profile.

1. Open **Family**.
2. Choose what they may do: **View Only** (they can see everything but change nothing) or **Can Edit** (they can add and update medicines, contacts and reminders).
3. Tap **Create invite code**.
4. Send them the 6-digit code with **Copy** or **Share**.
5. They install the app, sign in with Google, tap **Guardian User**, and enter the code where it says **“Invited by family?”**

They then see the same profile you do. You remain the owner and can remove anyone at any time from this screen.

> **One code, one person**
>
> Each code works once and expires after 7 days. Inviting two relatives means creating two codes. A code also carries the access level you chose — so if you change your mind between View Only and Can Edit, create a fresh code.



Picture 6. Guardian phone, step 12. Family members. A second relative is invited with a code and then sees the same elder.

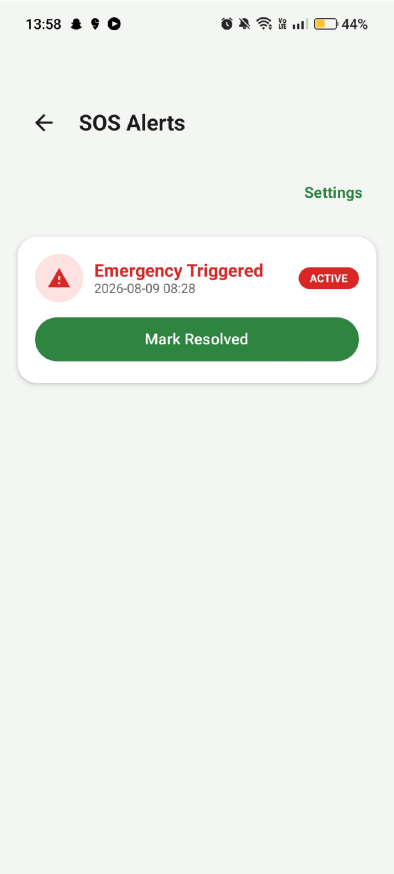
13. SOS alerts

What you receive when the elder presses the big red button.

A notification arrives on your phone straight away, with their name, the time, and a link to where they were. It arrives even if the app is closed, and it will still make a sound if you have muted the app's other notifications — an emergency should never be silenced by a setting.

1. Open **SOS Alerts** to see the alert, marked **ACTIVE** in red.
2. Call them, or use the map link to see where they are.
3. Once you have reached them and everything is fine, tap **Mark Resolved**.

Settings on that screen lets you write the message that is sent, using **{name}** where their name should appear.



Picture 7. Guardian phone, step 13. The SOS Alerts screen with an ACTIVE emergency, its time and the map link. This is the record the elder's SOS button creates.

Part 2 — Their phone

What the elder sees. Simple on purpose.

The elder's side is deliberately plain. There are no menus to get lost in, no settings that can break anything, and nothing that needs remembering. Six buttons, all of them large.

The home screen

It greets them by name — “Namaste, Kiran Pandey” — and shows six things.

Button	What happens
SOS (large, red)	Calls for help. Explained on the next page.
Medicines	Today's medicines. Shows a small label such as “1 due today”.
Contacts	Family photos. Tap a face to call that person.
Vitals	Record a blood pressure or sugar reading.
Videos	The shortcuts you added.
Settings (gear)	Text size, language, high contrast.

There is no way to accidentally leave the app or end up somewhere confusing. Pressing the phone's back button always returns them to this screen — it never closes the app.

Taking medicines

The part of the app they will use most.

1. At the scheduled time the phone shows a notification: **“Time for Thyroid Medicine”**.
2. They tap it, and the app opens **directly** on the medicine screen.
3. They tap **Start taking**.
4. One medicine at a time is shown — the name, the picture, and instructions such as “Breakfast · with water”.
5. They tap the big green ✓ **Taken**, or the red ✗ **Not taken**.
6. When they are done, a **“Great job!”** screen appears.

They can also open Medicines themselves at any time without waiting for a notification. Either way, their answer appears on your phone under Adherence.

> **If they take it early**
>
> Tapping Taken cancels that reminder, so the phone will not ask again later for something already taken.

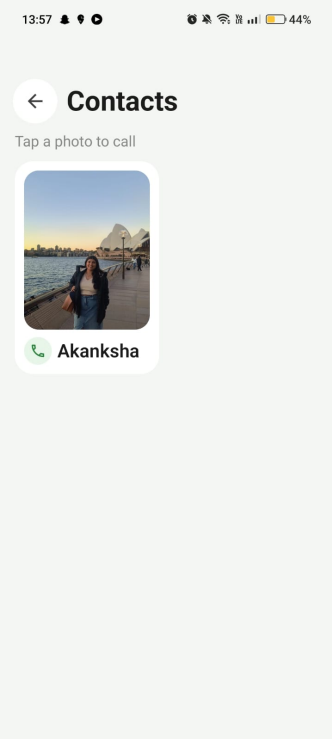
Calling someone

Faces, not phone numbers.

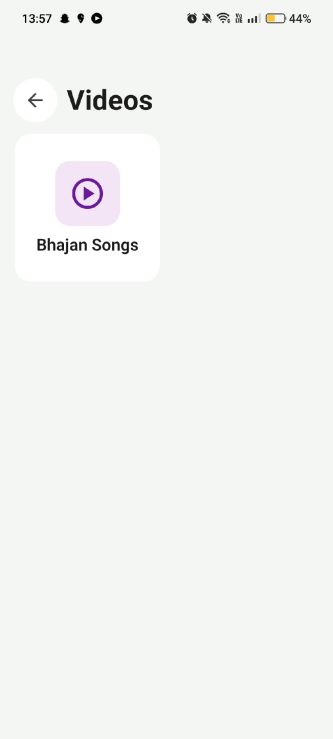
1. They tap **Contacts**.
2. They tap the photo of the person they want.
3. The phone asks **“Call Akanksha Pandey?”**

4 They tap **Yes, Call** — or **No** if they tapped by mistake.

The confirmation step is deliberate: it makes an accidental call almost impossible.



Picture 8. Elder phone. Contacts are faces, not names in a list. One tap on the photograph starts the call.



Picture 9. Elder phone. The Videos screen shows only the shortcuts the guardian switched on.

The SOS button

The most important button in the app.

1 They press the big red **SOS** button.

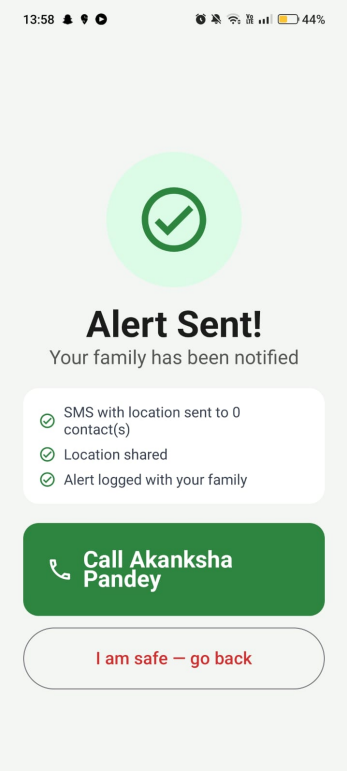
2 A countdown begins — **5 seconds** — with a large **“CANCEL — I'm OK”** button.

3 If they pressed it by mistake, tapping Cancel stops everything. Nothing is sent.

4 If the countdown finishes, the alert goes to every family member, along with where they are.

5 The screen then says **“Alert Sent! Your family has been notified”**, with a big green button to call their main contact.

> **If there is no internet**
>
> The screen says plainly that the alert did **not** go through, and offers two large buttons: **Send text to [name]**, which opens their messaging app with the emergency message and their location already written, and a button to call. The app never pretends help is coming when it is not.



Picture 10. Elder phone. What the elder sees after pressing SOS. Each line is an outcome the app actually observed — nothing is claimed that did not happen.

Recording a reading

The elder can record their own blood pressure or sugar.

1. They tap **Vitals**, then **Add reading**.
2. They choose Blood Pressure, Sugar, Temperature or Pulse.
3. They type the numbers and tap **Save reading**.

The date and time are filled in automatically, and the reading appears on your phone as well.

Settings

Three things, all designed for comfort.

Setting	What it does
Text size	Three sizes. Everything in the app grows, not just one screen.
Language	English, Hindi, Marathi or Gujarati. Each is shown in its own script on the phone. The whole elder side changes immediately.
High contrast	Darkens greys to near-black for easier reading in poor light or with weaker eyesight.

Worth doing on day one

Set the text size and language *with* them, and ask whether it is comfortable. It takes two minutes and makes the difference between an app they use and one they avoid.

Part 3 — An ordinary day

How the two phones work together once everything is set up.

At medicine time

On their phone	On your phone
A notification appears at the exact time you set.	Nothing yet.
They tap it and the medicine screen opens.	
They tap **Taken**.	The dose appears under **Adherence** as taken.
If they ignore it, nothing else happens on their phone.	The dose is recorded as **missed**, so you can follow it up.

When SOS is pressed

On their phone	On your phone
5-second countdown, with a Cancel button.	Nothing yet — the countdown may be cancelled.
The alert is sent with their location.	A notification arrives immediately, with their name, the time and a map link.
“Alert Sent!” and a large button to call family.	The alert shows as **ACTIVE** under SOS Alerts.
	You call them, then tap **Mark Resolved**.

Things worth knowing

- **Reminders work even if they never open the app.** The phone checks through the day on its own, and reminders survive the phone being switched off and on again.
- **Their answers are not lost without internet.** If they tap Taken while offline, it is saved on the phone and sent as soon as there is a connection.
- **You do not need to be signed in for alerts to reach you.** They arrive even when the app is closed.
- **Emergency alerts cannot be silenced** by turning off the app's other notifications.

Part 4 — When something is not right

The usual causes, and what to do about them.

What you see	What to do
The elder's phone still asks for a code	The code has been used already, or more than 7 days have passed. Open their profile on your phone — a fresh code will be there.
“This profile is already set up on another phone”	The profile was connected to a different phone. Only that phone can open it. Contact support if the old phone is gone.
Nothing appears on the elder's Medicines screen	The medicine has no schedule. Go to Medicines, tap **Schedule** under it, and set the days and time. A medicine on its own never appears.
The reminder did not go off	Check the day is selected in the schedule, and that the medicine's switch is on. Then check notifications are allowed for Care Companion in the phone's own settings.
Saving does nothing	Almost always the internet. Check the connection and try again — an error message should now tell you what went wrong.
Signing in with Google fails	The phone needs Google Play Services, which almost every Android phone has. Check the phone is online and that a Google account is added in its settings.
Text looks faint or hard to read	Turn on **High contrast** in the elder's Settings, and increase the text size.
They keep pressing SOS by accident	There is a 5-second countdown with a large Cancel button. Practise it together once, so they know a mistake is easily undone.

A worked example, start to finish

One medicine, from what you type to what everyone sees. If your own screens look like this, the app is working correctly.

What you do (input)	What the app does (output)
On your phone: Medicines → Add → name **Amlodipine 5 mg**, form **Tablet**, with water, after food → **Save**	The medicine appears on your Medicines list with those details. Nothing happens on the elder's phone yet — a medicine with no schedule is never shown to them.
Under it, tap **Schedule** → **Every day** → **Breakfast** → **08:00** → **Save**	The card now reads **Breakfast · 08:00**. Save stays greyed out until a meal slot is chosen — that is the app checking your entry, not a fault.
Nothing. Wait until 08:00 on the elder's phone.	A reminder appears on the elder's phone and, if the spoken reminder is on, it is read aloud in their language. Tapping it opens the medicine straight away.
The elder taps **Taken** (or says so out loud).	The reminder is removed so the same dose is never asked for twice. If they take it early, the 08:00 alarm is cancelled.
On your phone: open **Adherence**.	That dose is now marked taken, with its time. A dose nobody answers is shown as missed rather than quietly ignored.

> **How to tell a real problem from a slow connection**
>
> Every screen that saves something tells you what actually happened. If you see an error, the app could not reach the internet and your entry was kept to be sent again. If you see nothing at all, it saved.

Looking after the two phones

Looking after it	What to do
Charging	Charge the elder's phone at the same time every evening. A reminder cannot go off on a phone that is flat, and this is the single most common reason a dose is missed.
Battery saving	If the phone has an aggressive battery saver, allow Care Companion to run in the background. Without it Android may delay a reminder by several minutes.
Staying connected	Leave Wi-Fi on at home. Anything you change reaches the elder's phone the next time it is online; nothing is lost in the meantime.
Sound	Keep the elder's phone off silent and the volume up. Check it once a week — a muted phone looks exactly like a working one.
Restarting	After the phone is switched off and on again, open Care Companion once. Reminders are re-set automatically, but opening it confirms that they are.
Safe use	This app organises care. It does not measure anything medical by itself, and it is not a monitored alarm service. In a real emergency, call 108 as well as pressing SOS.

Getting back in if something goes wrong

- **The elder's phone was replaced.** Open their profile on your phone and share a fresh connect code with the new phone. The old phone stops having access.
- **You signed out by mistake.** Sign in again with the same Google account or mobile number. Everything is on the server, not on the phone, so nothing is lost.
- **The app is behaving oddly.** Close it fully and open it again. If that does not help, install the app file again over the top — your data is untouched.
- **You want to stop entirely.** Delete the elder's profile. That removes its medicines, contacts, readings and alerts for everyone.

Your information

Care Companion holds health information, and treats it that way.

- Only you, the family members you have invited, and the elder can see the profile. Nobody else can.
- Location is recorded **only** at the moment SOS is pressed. The app never follows anyone around.
- Nothing is sold, and nothing is used for advertising.
- Choosing a contact from your address book reads only that one contact. Your address book is never uploaded.
- Deleting a profile deletes its medicines, contacts, readings and alerts.

A last word

This app helps a family stay organised. It is not a medical device, it does not give medical advice, and it should never replace calling a doctor or the emergency services when something is wrong.